iSEE Lab

招生常见问题

Admissions FAQ

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阅读说明 / Notice

招生政策及相关要求以学校、学院当年正式通知和实际沟通为准。

Admissions policies and related requirements are subject to the official notices issued by the University and the School for the relevant year, as well as to actual communication with the lab.

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Q1. 怎么样才能加入我们小组?

How can I join the lab?

如果你是保研，最基本的前提是能拿到本校的保研资格，并且通过中大的预推免，这两个属于学校层面的硬门槛，如果没过我确实爱莫能助，毕竟我还没有强到可以修改学校招生系统。在这个基础上，如果你对我们组感兴趣，可以提前联系我。我看完你的材料之后，如果觉得你大概率比较合适，会安排一个组内面试。一般我会提前给你几篇论文，你选其中一篇做一个 presentation，然后再结合你的简历聊一聊，包括你做过什么、对什么感兴趣、以后想做什么。

如果你通过了我们小组的面试，我会再和你沟通，看是否需要给你预留研究生名额。有一点我比较在意，就是我不会超发 offer，所以如果我明确给你留了名额，我也希望你是真的认真考虑过，觉得我们组适合你，而不是先拿十几个 offer 再慢慢抽卡。我比较喜欢 self-motivated 的学生，不太喜欢天天 push，也不希望读研变成“老师每天追着你问进度，你每天躲着老师走”。我更希望你自己知道想要什么、想做到什么，我能做的是帮你往那个方向走，而不是把你塑造成我喜欢的样子。

当然，自由也不是完全躺平。我一直觉得比较好的状态是，不能在卷的地方躺平，也没必要在躺平的地方硬卷。我会尊重你的选择，但我目前还是比较想认真做科研，所以也希望你至少对科研有兴趣，愿意一起讨论问题，而不是看到论文就头疼、看到实验就想逃跑。

If you are applying through the recommendation based graduate admissions route (保研), two basic requirements apply. You must obtain recommendation eligibility from your home university and pass the preliminary admissions round at SYSU for candidates who are exempt from the entrance examination (预推免). These are firm requirements set at the university level. If you do not meet them, there is genuinely nothing I can do. After all, I am not yet powerful enough to rewrite the admissions system at the university. Once you meet those requirements, you are welcome to contact me in advance if our lab interests you. After I review your materials, I will arrange an internal interview if I think you are likely to be a good fit. I will usually send you several papers beforehand. You will choose one and give a presentation. We will then discuss your CV, including what you have done, what interests you, and what you would like to do in the future.

If you pass the internal interview, we will discuss whether I should reserve a place in the graduate program for you. One principle is important to me: I do not issue more offers than I have available places. If I explicitly hold a place for you, I hope you have considered the decision seriously and genuinely believe that our lab is right for you, rather than collecting a dozen offers first and treating the final choice like a gacha draw.

I prefer students who can motivate themselves. I do not enjoy pushing people every day. I also do not want graduate school to become a routine in which *your supervisor chases you for updates every day while you spend every day avoiding your supervisor*. I would much rather that you know what you want and what you hope to accomplish. My role is to help you move in that direction, not to shape you into the kind of student I prefer.

Of course, freedom does not mean doing nothing. I have always thought that a good balance means not choosing to *lie flat* where effort matters, while also refusing to join a rat race where no race is needed. I will respect your choices, but I am serious about research. I therefore hope that you have at least a genuine interest in research and are willing to discuss problems with us, rather than reacting to every paper with a headache and every experiment with an urge to run away.

Q2. 组内一般怎么带学生？

How does student supervision work in the lab?

刚进组的时候，我会结合你的背景和兴趣，和你一起商量一个研究方向，不会完全由我拍脑袋指定，毕竟最后真正每天盯着代码、跑实验、改论文的人是你，不是我。平时讨论的时候，我更多会帮你判断一些 high-level 的问题，比如这个思路大方向对不对、这个问题值不值得做、这个 idea 有没有意义、整个研究逻辑是不是合理、下一步应该往哪里走。至于特别具体的实现细节，我不一定都懂，这个我要提前坦白。我自己现在也基本每天会看论文，但事情确实比较多，不可能把每个方向、每篇论文的每个实现细节都吃透。不过我自己是偏理论出身的，现在组里涉及的大部分方向，包括比较前沿的工作，我多少都会了解一些，所以至少在“这个问题为什么值得做”“这个方向还能怎么想”这些事情上，我应该还是能提供一些帮助的。

如果你平时看到特别有意思的论文，也很欢迎直接发给我，我们可以一起看看、一起讨论。有时候你发现的新东西，说不定比我看到得还早。具体实现上，我们大组有很多师兄师姐，也有比较丰富的经验，工程上的一些坑，他们可能比我更清楚。论文我也会帮你改，尤其是第一篇论文，我一般会改得比较细。第一轮我通常不会直接逐字逐句帮你改，而是先给一些 high-level 的建议，比如整体结构怎么组织、故事怎么讲、哪部分逻辑不够顺，以及为什么要这样调整。第二轮我会自己下手改一些比较具体的内容，包括表达、逻辑和细节。我也希望你改完之后再回过头想一下，为什么这里要这么写，因为我更希望你以后能自己写好，能慢慢成为一位能独当一面的 Researcher。

When you first join the lab, I will work with you to identify a research direction based on your background and interests. I will not simply make a unilateral choice on a whim. After all, you will be the person who looks at the code, runs the experiments, and revises the papers every day, rather than me. During regular discussions, I focus more on questions at a higher level. Is the overall direction sound? Is the problem worth studying? Does the idea matter? Is the research narrative logically coherent? What should the next step be? I may not understand every specific implementation detail, and I want to be honest about that from the start. I still read papers almost every day, but I have many other responsibilities and cannot master every detail in every paper across every area. My background is primarily theoretical, and I have at least a working understanding of most areas covered by the lab, including recent work at the frontier. On questions such as *Why is this problem worth studying?* and *What other ways are there to approach this direction?*, I should still be able to offer useful guidance.

If you encounter a particularly interesting paper, you are very welcome to send it directly to me so that we can read and discuss it together. Sometimes you may find something new before I see it. For implementation details, the broader iSEE group includes many senior students with extensive practical experience, and they may understand some engineering pitfalls better than I do. I also help revise papers, especially the first paper you write, which I usually review in considerable detail. During the first round, I do not usually edit every sentence directly. I first give suggestions at a higher level, including how to organize the overall structure, how to present the research story, which parts of the reasoning do not flow smoothly, and why those changes are needed. During the second round, I directly revise more specific aspects, including wording, logic, and details. After you finish the revisions, I hope you will look back and consider the reason for each change. I want you to become able to write well on your own and gradually grow into a researcher who can work independently.

Q3. 有没有补贴?

Are stipends available?

有。除了国家和学校层面的补贴之外，组里每个月也会额外提供一定的补贴。如果发表 A 类论文，也会有额外奖励。如果参与横向项目，会根据项目规模、你的参与程度和实际贡献发放补贴，做得比较多、贡献比较大的情况下，补贴也会比较可观。简单来说就是，正常科研有补贴，做出成果有奖励，额外干项目也不会让你白干。

Yes. In addition to stipends provided at national and university levels, the lab provides an extra monthly allowance. Publications classified as Category A under the relevant university scheme also receive additional rewards. If you participate in a project commissioned by a company or another outside partner, which Chinese universities commonly call a *horizontal project*, compensation will reflect the scale of the project, your level of participation, and your actual contribution. The allowance can be quite generous when the workload and contribution are substantial. Put simply, regular research comes with a stipend, strong results earn rewards, and extra project work will not be unpaid.

Q4. 组内打不打卡?

Do students need to clock in?

不打卡。我不太在意你几点来、几点走。你可以早上七点开始干活，也可以中午才起床。你可以白天工作，也可以晚上突然灵感爆发。偶尔哪天状态不好，出去玩一下、放松一下，我也完全能理解，毕竟我自己读书的时候也不是每天标准朝九晚五。我更看重的是你有没有自己的节奏，以及事情最后有没有推进。所以还是那句话，我比较希望学生是 self-motivated 的。不打卡的意思是“你自己管理自己”，不是“从此失联”。如果一个月以后我问你“最近在干吗”，你说“老师，我在寻找自己”，这个可能还是不太行。

No. I do not care much about what time you arrive or leave. You may start working at seven in the morning, or you may not get out of bed until noon. You may work during the day, or suddenly have a burst of inspiration at night. If your energy is low on a particular day and you want to go out, have some fun, and recharge, I completely understand. I did not follow a perfect nine to five schedule every day when I was a student either. What matters more to me is whether you have found a rhythm that works for you and whether the work ultimately moves forward. So once again, I prefer students who can motivate themselves. Not clocking in means *you manage yourself*. It does not mean *you vanish without a trace*. If I ask after a month, *What have you been doing lately?*, and you reply, *Professor, I have been searching for myself*, that still probably will not work.

Q5. 组里有没有杂活?

Will I be expected to handle miscellaneous lab duties?

有，但总体来说不会特别多。我平时自己事情也很多，如果所有事情都完全自己做，我大概也会喘不过气，所以确实偶尔需要学生帮忙分担一些组里的事务，比如招生、买设备、管理服务器、整理材料，或者参与学院和 iSEE 组织的一些活动。有时候也会需要帮忙准备 PPT 的素材或者做其中一部分，不过一般 PPT 的主体内容还是我自己做，不太会出现“老师明天汇报，今晚学生从第一页做到最后一页”的情况。如果某段时间杂活确实比较多，也会根据情况发一定

的补贴。

写本子也是一样，我不会直接扔给你一句“来，帮我写个基金”。最多可能让你帮忙找一些相关论文、收集一点材料、画图，或者写非常少的一部分内容，主体还是我自己写。如果你特别担心“进去以后会不会天天干杂活”，也很欢迎你直接去问我现在的学生，他们的评价肯定比我自己说更客观。毕竟如果我说“我从来不给学生安排杂活”，可信度可能确实有限。

Yes, but not a great deal overall. I also have many responsibilities, and I would probably be overwhelmed if I insisted on doing everything myself. From time to time, students may therefore need to help with matters in the lab, such as admissions and recruitment, purchasing equipment, managing servers, organizing materials, or taking part in activities organized by the School or iSEE. Occasionally, you may also be asked to gather material for a PPT deck or prepare part of it. However, I normally create the main content myself. The arrangement is unlikely to become *the supervisor presents tomorrow, so the student must build the entire deck tonight*. If the volume of miscellaneous work becomes unusually high for a period, additional compensation will be provided as appropriate.

The same applies to grant proposals. I will not simply hand you a one sentence instruction such as *Please help me write a grant proposal*. At most, I may ask you to find relevant papers, collect background material, prepare figures, or draft a very small portion. I will still write the main proposal myself. If you are especially worried that joining the lab might mean spending every day on miscellaneous tasks, you are very welcome to ask my current students directly. Their assessment should be more objective than mine. After all, if I claimed that *I never assign miscellaneous work to students*, that claim would understandably have limited credibility.

Q6. 学生要不要做横向项目？

Are students expected to work on industry projects?

有可能会。其实研究生一般都会参与老师的课题，只不过有些是纵向，有些是横向。纵向项目相对自由一些，很多时候你的主要目标就是做科研、写论文。横向项目通常更偏工程落地，可能需要做一个 demo、做一个系统，或者最后交付一个产品和结果。但我不会为了接项目而乱接横向，我会尽量只接我们确实能做，而且和组里学生研究方向比较相关的项目。最好是你做这个项目的时候，既能学到东西，又能积累一些以后找工作能写进简历的经历，而不是做半年最后发现唯一的收获是“熟练使用 Excel”。

我们组的主要任务还是科研，所以一般也不会给某个学生塞很多横向。如果

需要你参与，我会尽量控制在一个比较合理的量。同时，横向项目会根据你的参与程度和贡献给科研津贴，做得多、贡献大，补贴也会相应比较高。现在我确实也会适当接一些横向项目，原因也很现实，一个组要有计算资源、设备、机器人、服务器和各种科研支出，总得想办法养活。所以这件事我觉得大家互相理解就好，我尽量保证项目对你有价值，你也在有余力的时候帮组里一起把事情做好。

There is a possibility. Graduate students generally participate in research projects led by supervisors. Some are *vertical projects*, usually academic grants funded by government agencies. Others are *horizontal projects*, meaning collaborations commissioned by outside partners and often connected with industry. Vertical projects tend to allow more academic freedom, and the main objective is often to conduct research and publish papers. Horizontal projects usually focus more on practical implementation. They may require a demo, a system, or final delivery of a product and concrete results. However, I will not accept projects indiscriminately merely to obtain funding. I will try to accept only projects that the lab can genuinely handle and that relate closely to student research directions in the lab. Ideally, each project should help you learn something and give you experience worth listing on your CV when you later look for a job. I do not want you to spend six months on a project only to discover that the sole result was proficiency in Excel.

Research remains the primary mission of the lab, so we generally will not give any student an unreasonable number of horizontal projects. If I need you to participate, I will try to keep the workload at a reasonable level. These projects also provide research allowances based on levels of participation and contribution. More work and greater contribution lead to higher compensation. I do currently accept some horizontal projects for a practical reason. A lab needs computing resources, equipment, robots, servers, and funding for many forms of research expenditure. Someone has to find a way to support all of this. I think mutual understanding is what matters here. I will do my best to ensure that each project offers genuine value to you. In return, I hope that when you have enough capacity, you will help the lab complete the work well.

Q7. 能不能去实习?

Can I do an internship?

可以。我完全理解大家以后需要找工作，也理解一段好的实习经历对求职很重要，所以我会给学生留实习时间。比较常规的情况是研二暑假出去实习，大概三个月左右。但我个人还是觉得，研究生刚入学的时候应该先有一点“研究生的样子”，不要一进组就问“老师，我什么时候能去实习？”你以后可以打工很多很多年，但能比较心无旁骛地坐下来做科研的时间，可能也就这么几年，所以研一我更希望你先把科研基础打好，学会怎么做研究，也尽量有一些阶段性成果。

当然，规则不是绝对的。如果你研一就已经发了论文，而且非常明确自己硕士毕业就是想找工作，也确实遇到了很好的实习机会，那你研一结束就去，我也不会反对。反过来，如果你科研一直不太顺，研二结束还没有什么产出，我会不建议你去实习。注意，是“不建议”，不是“不允许”。如果你真的非常坚定想去，我一般也不会强行卡你，但前提是你自己要有清楚的规划，知道回来以后科研怎么补，最后怎么满足毕业要求。自由是有的，但毕业还是得靠自己毕业，这个锅最后不能甩给实习。

Yes. I completely understand that everyone will eventually need to look for a job, and that a good internship can make a real difference during a job search, so I do reserve time for students to complete internships. A typical arrangement is an internship of around three months during the summer after the second year. Even so, I think new graduate students should first spend some time actually being graduate students, instead of joining the lab and immediately asking, *Professor, when can I start an internship?* You will have many years to work for a living, but perhaps only these few years when you can sit down and focus on research with relatively few distractions. During the first year, I would therefore prefer that you build a solid foundation, learn how to conduct research, and try to produce some meaningful progress.

Of course, this is not an absolute rule. If you have already published a paper during your first year, know clearly that you want to look for a job after graduation, and find an excellent internship opportunity, I will not object if you take the internship after that year. Conversely, if your research has made little progress and you still have few results by the end of your second year, I would advise you not to take an internship. Please notice that I am saying *advise against it*, rather than *forbid it*. If you are truly determined to go, I generally will not stand in your way, but you need a clear plan for how to catch up on research after you return and how to meet the graduation requirements. You have freedom, but graduation remains your own responsibility. In the end, you cannot use the internship as an excuse.

Q8. 要不要提前进组?

Should I join the lab before formal enrollment?

这个主要取决于你自己的时间安排，不是硬性要求，我也不会把是否提前进组作为考察积极性或者后续评价的标准。如果你本科学校还有课程、毕业设计、实习或其他安排，完全可以按照自己的节奏来，我不会因为你没有提前来，就觉得你态度有问题。不过，从时间规划的角度，我确实比较建议提前进组。目前组内大部分硕士生都会提前过来，并在组里完成本科毕业设计，这样可以先熟悉研究方向、科研流程和组内环境，避免正式入学以后再从头适应。硕士阶段的时间

其实很短，如果能够提前打好基础，争取在研一完成一项比较完整的研究工作，后面无论是继续做科研、出去实习还是准备找工作，安排都会更灵活，压力也会小一些。提前进组期间，组里也会提供一定的住房补贴。简单来说，提前进组是一个建议，不是一项隐形要求。如果时间合适，提前来通常会更从容，如果确实不方便，正常入学也完全没有问题。

This mainly depends on your own schedule. It is not mandatory, and I will not treat early participation as a measure of enthusiasm or as a criterion in later evaluations. If you still have courses, an undergraduate thesis or capstone project, an internship, or other commitments at your current university, you are entirely free to proceed at your own pace. I will not assume that there is a problem with your attitude simply because you did not arrive early. From a planning perspective, however, I do recommend joining the lab in advance. Most students who enter our master program join early and complete their undergraduate capstone projects in the lab. This gives them time to become familiar with the research directions, research process, and lab environment before formal enrollment, instead of starting the adjustment process from zero afterward. The time available in a master program is actually quite limited. If you can build a foundation early and aim to complete a reasonably substantial research project during your first year, you will have more flexibility and less pressure later, whether you continue with research, take an internship, or prepare for the job market. The lab also provides some housing support during the period before formal enrollment. Put simply, joining early is a recommendation, not a hidden requirement. If your schedule allows it, arriving early will usually give you more breathing room. If it is genuinely inconvenient, joining at the normal time is completely fine.

Q9. 组内学生毕业以后一般去哪?

Where do students from the lab usually go after graduation?

我自己的学生目前还没有毕业，所以如果我现在跟你说“我的学生毕业以后百分之多少去大厂，百分之多少去高校”，那基本属于现场编数据。不过从 iSEE 大组过去学生的情况来看，毕业去向整体还是很不错的，有人去大厂，有人去高校，也有人继续做科研或者读博。具体最后去哪，还是看你自己更想走哪条路。如果你想做科研，我会尽量帮你把科研能力培养起来。如果你以后想去工业界，我也会尽量让你在科研之外积累一些有价值的项目和实习经历。我不太希望所有学生都走同一条路，每个人适合的生活本来就不一样。

None of my own students has graduated yet, so if I were to claim that a certain percentage joined major technology companies and another percentage went to universities, I would basically be inventing statistics on the spot. Based on the experience of past graduates from the broader iSEE group, however, the overall outcomes have been very good. Some have joined major technology companies, some have taken positions at universities, and others have continued with research or pursued a PhD. Your eventual destination still depends on the path you want to follow. If you want to pursue research, I will do my best to help you develop the necessary research skills. If you plan to enter industry, I will also try to help you gain valuable project and internship experience alongside your research. I do not expect every student to follow the same path. Different ways of life suit different people.

Q10. 组会一般怎么开?

How are lab meetings usually run?

正常情况下，组会每周开一次，每次由部分学生汇报，频率大致保持在每个人一个月一次。我比较鼓励大家分享自己的研究进展，包括最近读了什么论文、有什么新的想法，或者研究中遇到了什么问题，内容和形式都不做特别限制。组会主要是为了把问题拿出来一起讨论，不是每个月进行一次小型答辩。汇报尽量精简，不需要花很多时间制作 PPT，更不用反复调整模板、配色和动画。你可以用几页简单的 PPT，也可以直接在白板上讲，甚至觉得不用 PPT 也能讲清楚，那就不用做。即使最近一直在跑实验、还在等结果，或者实验暂时没有成功，也可以简单说说自己尝试了什么、有什么思考，以及下一步准备怎么做。

组会之外，如果你遇到比较具体的问题，或者觉得有些内容需要更深入地讨论，也可以随时单独找我约时间聊。1v1 不是把组会单独再开一遍，也不是专门用来追进度，主要是帮你把目前的想法和进展梳理清楚，看看真正卡住的地方在哪里，下一步应该怎么推进。你不需要等到有完整结果才来，哪怕只有一个没想明白的问题、一个不确定的想法，或者一组失败的实验，都可以直接拿来讨论。我们可以一起判断问题出在研究方向、实验设计还是具体实现上，也看看有哪些事情是我可以帮上忙的。

Under normal circumstances, we hold one lab meeting each week, with a subset of students presenting at each meeting. This works out to roughly one presentation per student each month. I encourage everyone to share research progress, including papers that they have recently read, new ideas, or problems encountered during research. There are no rigid requirements for content or format. The purpose of a lab meeting is to bring problems forward and discuss them together, not to hold a miniature defense every month. Presentations should be concise. There is no need to spend a great deal of time making slides, let alone repeatedly adjusting templates, color schemes, and animations. You can use a few simple slides, explain things directly at the whiteboard, or skip slides entirely if you can make the ideas clear without them.

Even if you have recently done nothing but run experiments and wait for results, or if the experiments have not yet worked, you can simply explain what you tried, what you have learned or considered, and what you plan to do next.

Outside the regular lab meetings, if you encounter a specific problem or feel that a topic needs deeper discussion, you can arrange an individual meeting with me at any time. This is not a private repeat of the lab meeting, nor is it a session devoted only to checking progress. The main purpose is to help you organize your current ideas and progress, identify the real obstacle, and decide how to move forward. You do not need to wait until you have complete results. One unresolved question, one tentative idea, or one set of failed experiments is enough for a discussion. Together, we can determine whether the issue lies in the research direction, the experimental design, or the implementation, and identify any way I may be able to help.

Q11. 组内博士毕业要求是什么?

What are the PhD graduation requirements in the lab?

我比较希望博士期间能形成一个相对完整的研究体系。大致来说，最好能够有 3–4 篇论文，一起构成一个完整的博士研究框架。当然，我也知道科研这件事情不可能保证每一次都成功，有时候一个 idea 想得很好，实验就是不行。有时候做了一年，最后发现别人提前三个月发出来了。还有时候纯粹就是运气不好。所以我不会要求你每一篇都必须是 A 类。

大致来说，我希望里面至少能有 2 篇 A 类工作。如果有一篇特别有分量，比如 TPAMI、TRO、JMLR 这类很强的工作，具体要求也可以根据实际情况讨论。而且不同方向的论文发表难度差异很大，哪怕同一个大方向下面，不同小方向也完全不一样，所以我不会完全拿一个数字卡死所有人，最终还是会结合你的研究方向、工作质量和整个博士期间形成的研究体系来判断。我允许科研失败，但我希望你的博士几年下来，至少能够形成一套属于自己的东西，而不是单纯攒够几篇论文就结束。

I hope that a PhD will result in a reasonably coherent body of research. As a rough target, it would be best to have three or four papers that together form a complete framework for doctoral research. Of course, I also understand that research cannot succeed every time. Sometimes an idea looks excellent, but the experiments simply refuse to cooperate. Sometimes you work on something for a year, only to discover that someone else published it three months earlier. Sometimes you are simply unlucky. I therefore will not require every paper to qualify as a Class A publication under the relevant institutional classification.

As a general expectation, I would like the body of work to include at least two Class

A publications. If you have one particularly substantial paper, such as a strong contribution published in TPAMI, TRO, or JMLR, we can discuss the exact requirements in light of the circumstances. The difficulty of publication also varies greatly across research areas, and even across subareas within the same broader field. I will therefore not hold everyone to one rigid numerical threshold. The final assessment will consider your research direction, the quality of your work, and the coherent research program that you have developed throughout the PhD. I can accept research projects that fail, but by the end of those doctoral years, I hope you will have built something intellectually your own instead of merely collecting enough papers to graduate.

Q12. 怎么判断自己适不适合读博?

How can I tell whether a PhD is right for me?

我觉得，适不适合读博，其实很难靠一张清单判断。读博当然需要能力，但更重要的，可能是你能不能接受一种缓慢、不确定，而且经常没有即时回报的生活。你会花很长时间读文献，反复修改，面对失败，也可能努力了很久，最后只证明原来的想法走不通。太功利的人未必不能读博，只是可能会读得比较辛苦，因为博士阶段很难保证每一份投入都有清晰的回报。如果你总是在计算这几年能换来多少薪水、职位和社会认可，很容易在过程中怀疑它到底值不值得。真正支撑一个人走下去的，往往是对某个问题的好奇，是在没有人催促、没有人鼓掌的时候，依然愿意多想一点、多走一步。当然，你也不需要一开始就非常确定。如果不知道自己喜不喜欢研究，可以先读一个硕士，真正靠近这种生活，看看自己是否享受阅读、思考、写作和独自解决问题的过程，也看看自己能不能承受它的孤独、重复和挫败。

我当年其实也没有多么坚定，只是不抗拒，而且隐约觉得这是一件我愿意尝试的事。我想，人生还很长，以后大概还有几十年要工作，那为什么不能先拿出几年，认真做一点自己真正喜欢的事情。它未必立刻有用，也未必能让我赚更多的钱，甚至未必会把我带到一个更好的终点，但至少在那几年里，我可以安静地追问一些问题，认真地读一些书，也可以暂时不急着成为别人期待中的样子。对我来说，读博像是一场修行，也像是给自己的人生留出一段不那么功利的时间。也许很多年以后，等我离开这个世界，墓碑上可以写着 Dr.。那两个字母未必代表我有多成功，却可以提醒别人，也提醒曾经的自己，我这一生曾经为好奇心停留过，也曾经把生命里的一小段时间，完整地交给过热爱。

I think it is very difficult to decide whether a PhD is right for you by working through a checklist. A PhD certainly requires ability, but what may matter even more is whether you can accept a way of life that moves slowly, remains uncertain, and often offers no immediate reward. You will spend long periods reading the literature, revising work again and again, and confronting failure. You may also work hard for a long time, only to establish that the original idea does not work. A strong focus on practical returns does not necessarily mean that you cannot do a PhD. It may simply make the experience more difficult, because doctoral study cannot guarantee a clear return for every investment of time and effort. If you constantly calculate how much salary, status, or social recognition those years will bring, it is easy to start wondering whether the entire journey is worthwhile. What truly sustains a person is often curiosity about a particular question, along with the willingness to think a little further and take one more step even when no one is pushing and no one is applauding. Of course, you do not need to be completely certain at the beginning. If you do not know whether you enjoy research, you can first pursue graduate study at the master level and experience this way of life more closely. See whether you enjoy reading, thinking, writing, and solving problems independently, and whether you can tolerate the solitude, repetition, and frustration that come with them.

I was not particularly certain back then. I simply did not resist the idea and had a vague sense that it was something I was willing to try. Life is long, I thought, and I would probably have several decades of work ahead of me. Why not first set aside a few years to pursue something I genuinely enjoyed with full attention? It might not be immediately useful, might not help me earn more money, and might not even lead me to a better destination. But at least during those years, I could quietly keep asking questions, read books seriously, and temporarily stop rushing to become the person others expected me to be. To me, doing a PhD is a form of personal discipline, and also a way to reserve a period of life that is not governed quite so much by practical gain. Perhaps many years from now, when I leave this world, my gravestone can carry the title *Dr.* Those two letters may not mean that I was especially successful, but they can remind other people and the person I once was that at some point in this life, I paused for curiosity and gave a small stretch of my time, wholly, to something I loved.

Q13. 如果想进一步了解我们组，应该怎么联系？

How should I contact the lab if I want to learn more?

如果你目前还处在了解阶段，想知道组里的研究方向、日常氛围、指导方式或者真实体验，**可以联系组内任意一位学生**。我的个人主页上列出了他们的邮箱。很多问题由学生回答可能比由我回答更加直接和客观，毕竟老师说自己组里很好，多少有一点“卖家秀”的嫌疑。如果你已经认真看完这份 Q&A，对我们的研究方向和培养方式有了基本了解，并且确实有意向申请加入我们组，建议优先通过邮件联系我：**zhaozhlin@mail.sysu.edu.cn**。邮件标题请统一写成：

【已阅 QA】申请类型－姓名－毕业院校－预计入学年份

例如：

【已阅 QA】硕士－乌萨奇－拔草大学－ **2027** 年入学

请务必按照上述格式填写邮件标题。设置这个格式不是为了故意为难大家，而是因为我每天能够处理邮件的时间有限，也希望双方在开始沟通之前，都先花一点时间判断彼此是否合适。对于没有按照上述格式发送、内容又明显属于群发模板的邮件，我可能不会回复。如果你愿意认真了解我们，我也会愿意认真了解你。

If you are still exploring and would like to learn about the research directions, working atmosphere, supervision approach, or actual student experience in the lab, **you are welcome to contact any current student in the lab**. The email addresses of current students are listed on my personal homepage. Students may be able to answer many questions more directly and objectively than I can. After all, when an advisor says that the lab is wonderful, the result can sound a little like a sales pitch. If you have carefully read this Q&A, developed a basic understanding of our research directions and training approach, and are genuinely interested in applying to join the lab, the preferred way to contact me is by email at **zhaozhlin@mail.sysu.edu.cn**. For an email written in English, please use the following subject format:

[QA Read] Application Type - Name - Previous University - Entry Year

For example:

[QA Read] Master - Usagi - Weeding University - 2027 Entry

Please make sure to follow the exact subject format above when writing in English. This format is not intended to make things deliberately difficult. I have limited time each day for email, and I also hope that before we begin communicating, both sides will take a little time to decide whether we might be a good fit. I may not reply to messages that do not follow the format above and are clearly generic templates sent to many recipients. If you are willing to take the time to understand the lab seriously, I will be equally willing to take the time to understand you.